

Use these to elevate your writing and gain marks in sentence structures

1. EM DASH (—) = Connect a Sentence to a Fragment for extra detail

An em dash adds an extra detail, description, or clarification after a complete sentence.

Formula: [Complete Sentence] — [Fragment / extra detail]

THREE EASY USES:

1 Fragment begins with -ING form of the verb

Use an -ing word to show the result or consequence of the sentence.

Mobile phones help students feel connected — allowing them to stay in contact around the clock.

Your example (sentence — ...ing fragment):

2 Fragment begins with WH- words (which, who, when, where)

Use a wh- fragment to give extra information about a person, place, or thing just mentioned.

My team took part in the Karachi United tournament — which has been famous for over ten years.

Your example (sentence — which/who/when fragment):

3 Insert a name or extra detail in the middle of a sentence

Place a name or descriptor between two em dashes to insert it into a sentence without breaking the flow.

My best friend — Maham — was going to accompany me. | My rival for the past decade — Azaan — stared at me across the room.

Your example (sentence — name — rest of sentence):

2. COLON (:) = Reason / Statement : Result / Explanation

Formula: [Statement or reason] : [result, explanation, or list]

She had one goal: to pass her O-Levels with straight As.

The result was clear: he had studied all night.

Your example (statement : result):

Get these right every time — they are easy marks students consistently lose

1. CORRECT DIALOGUE WRITING FORMAT (Case 1 Only)

Use this format when the speaker's name comes **BEFORE** what they said.

Name of Speaker	Synonym of 'said'	,	" (open quote)	Quote / dialogue	Punct. mark	" (close quote)

"Synonyms of said: exclaimed, replied, whispered, shouted, muttered, announced, declared, insisted, argued"

COMPLETE EXAMPLES:

Maham exclaimed, "I cannot believe we won!"

Miss Jaweria announced, "The results are out."

He whispered, "I was never informed about this."

CRITICAL RULES: (1) Comma always goes **BEFORE** the opening quote mark. (2) Punctuation mark goes **INSIDE** the closing quote. (3) Each new speaker = new paragraph.

Write your own dialogue (Name + synonym + , + " + quote + punctuation + ") :

Saad replied, "I don't want it."

2. TRANSITION WORDS IN SUMMARY WRITING — Punctuation Rule

When you use a transition word to begin a new point, **ALWAYS** use this formula:

[Previous sentence] . or ; [Transition word] , [new clause]

Full stop **OR** semicolon **BEFORE** the transition word. Comma **AFTER** the transition word.

Common transition words for summary writing:

Furthermore	Moreover	Therefore	Thus	Similarly
Ultimately	However	Nevertheless	In addition	Consequently

EXAMPLES:

conclusively → last point

WRONG: The dolphin is intelligent. Furthermore it can communicate.

WRONG: The dolphin is intelligent; Furthermore, it can communicate.

RIGHT: . The dolphin is intelligent. Furthermore, it can communicate.

RIGHT: ; The dolphin is intelligent; furthermore, it can communicate.

KEY: "Furthermore" with capital F = **ALWAYS** after a full stop. "furthermore" lowercase = **ALWAYS** after a semicolon. Never a comma before the transition word alone.

Sentence and Fragment

What is a sentence?

Subject + Verb

Person performing the verb

→ Noun

→ Miss Jaweria
→ Excitement

→ Pronoun

→ She
→ It

Note: 'ing' form of the verb is
a gerund → NOT a verb

Action
(Anything you do)

To play

Helping

[is, am, are, was, were, has, have, had]

Examples:

→ It plays

Miss Jaweria teaches English

Sub

V

What is a fragment?

Anything that is not a sentence

1. It does not have a subject ✓
plays in the park

2. It does not have a verb ✓
-- The greatest of all time
-- The one and only

3. If you begin it with a conjunction. ✓

Examples: but I love cold palmer.

because he hates me.

to love

Summary:

10 Marks:

Essay:

15 Marks:

Directed Writing:

15 Marks:

 $\frac{40}{100}$

= .- Punctuation

.- Sentence Structures

.- Grammar

.- Vocabulary

.- Spelling

Rough estimate ~ 8 marks

"The use of a variety of complex punctuation marks used correctly."

① variety of complex punctuation marks used correctly. ② complicated

- Comma
- Fullstop
- Question mark
- Semicolon (;)



Not Complex

→ Colon (:)

→ Em dash (—)

PUNCTUATION

Ways to connect two sentences?

a) Fullstop

Michael plays basketball . Jordan watches him.

b) Semicolon

→ if you have any two remotely connected sentences, you can use a semicolon to connect them.

Michael plays basketball ; Jordan watches him.

My mom is a chef ; my dad is a trader.

c) COMMA + conjunction

Michael plays basketball , and Jordan watches him. X

d) Use of colon :- (The first sentence has to be reason, second is the result)
As a result 1st use → Reason : Result

I stayed up all night studying : I scored an A*.

I was late to school : they did not let me in.

I went to buy groceries: eggs, bread, muffins etcetra.

Ways to connect a sentence and fragment?

1st use:

Comma

a)

Since I was born

,

I have been scared of heights.

Fragment

Sentence

b) Sentence + Fragment

She is like my sister , because I have grown up with her

Non-essential information:

Em dashes:-

Sentence and a fragment

Two sentences

a) Start

My best friend — Maham will go to Yale

fragment subject sentence

(The most famous game these days) — Padel won the award

subject verb

b) End:-

Do not be late to the party — the one scheduled on Friday

verb sub

c) Two em dashes (middle)

Sarah and James — who recently got married — are best friends

sub (who " ") verb

Exam Hack of the Day

Direct Speech

Rule 1

Follow this exact structure for direct speech. Use both formats.

When you are adding dialogues, try to add them in both formats

① Structure:

The name of the speaker + of said + "Quote" + Punctuation mark (., ! / ? >)

Example 1: Mahima answered, "What's your guess?"

Rule 2

Two dialogues together must always be on separate lines.

Denji groaned, "I have been sitting here all night." (leave this space)

"She may not be here, but I am," boasted Power.

Rule 3

Always put spoken words in double inverted commas.

Shees ~~so~~ pointed towards my right knee and screamed, "so meone get the medic, quick!" All I remberremember was I sprinting like a cheetah, but tdown the field, but

Rule 4

Always capitalise the first letter of speech, even if it's mid-sentence.

When you are adding dialogues, try to add them in both formats

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Example 1: Mahima answered, "What's your guess?"

Rule 5

Always put the punctuation (full stop / ? / !) inside the quotation marks.

② "Quote" + Punctuation mark inside the dialogue + Synonym of said + Name of the speaker

Example 2:- "Just a few minutes more," chuckled Reze.

From the Examiner Report:

reporting clauses. Additionally, many candidates wrote their direct speech continuously, rather than beginning a new line for each new speaker, which sometimes led to difficulties in comprehending who was speaking and to whom, thus disrupting the narrative. Some responses also relied too heavily on dialogue, and

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From the next line → Denji groaned, "I have been sitting here all night." "She may not be here, but I am," boasted Power.

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Punctuation mark inside the dialogue

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